Nimbus Cycles Employee Handbook 2026

1. About Nimbus Cycles

Nimbus Cycles is an electric bicycle company founded in 2014 in Pune by Meera Kulkarni and Arjun Rao. Meera Kulkarni is the Chief Executive Officer, and Arjun Rao serves as the Chief Technology Officer. The company began as a small workshop with six people and has since grown to 240 employees across two locations.

The head office is in Pune, where the design, software and sales teams work. The manufacturing plant is in Coimbatore, where all frames are welded and every bicycle is assembled and tested. Nimbus Cycles sells three models: the Zephyr 500, a city commuter bicycle; the Ridge 700, a mountain model; and the Breeze 300, a lightweight folding bicycle for short trips.

The company mission is to make everyday travel cleaner and cheaper. Nimbus Cycles states that its goal is to put one million electric bicycles on the road by the year 2032. This handbook explains the rules and benefits for all employees and the policies that apply to customers who buy a Nimbus bicycle. Every new employee receives a printed copy on the first day and must confirm in writing that they have read it within two weeks of joining.

2. Working Hours and Leave

Standard working hours at Nimbus Cycles are from 9:30 in the morning to 6:00 in the evening, Monday to Friday. Core hours, when every employee should be available for meetings, are from 11:00 in the morning to 4:00 in the afternoon. Outside the core hours, employees may start and finish a little earlier or later, as long as they complete their daily hours.

Each employee receives 24 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. In addition, every employee gets 10 days of paid sick leave per year. Unused annual leave can be carried forward to the next year, but the carry-forward is limited to a maximum of 8 days. Any leave above that limit expires on 31 December.

Maternity leave is 26 weeks of fully paid leave. Paternity leave is 10 working days, which must be taken within three months of the birth or adoption of the child. Leave requests of more than five days in a row must be submitted at least 14 days in advance. Short leave of one or two days can be requested with a day's notice, and the manager will normally approve it unless a critical product launch is under way. Public holidays are announced in January every year and are published on the intranet.

3. Remote and Hybrid Work

Nimbus Cycles follows a hybrid work model. Employees in the Pune head office work from the office three days a week, on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday. Mondays and Fridays are remote days. Employees at the Coimbatore plant who work on the assembly line must be on site every working day, because their work cannot be done remotely.

Employees who work remotely receive a remote work allowance of Rs 1,500 per month, which is paid together with the salary. The allowance is meant to cover internet and electricity costs at home. It is not paid for days spent on business travel.

To work remotely on a day that is normally an office day, an employee must submit a request on the HR portal, which is called PeopleDesk. The manager must respond within 2 working days. If the manager does not respond in that time, the request is escalated to the department head. Employees who work remotely must be reachable on the company chat tool during core hours and must keep their camera on for team meetings that have more than three participants. Remote work from another city or country for more than ten days in a year needs written approval from the HR head.

4. Travel and Expenses

Employees who travel for business are reimbursed for reasonable expenses. The daily meal allowance for domestic travel is Rs 800. The hotel limit is Rs 6,000 per night in the metro cities of Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Kolkata, and Rs 4,000 per night in all other cities. Employees who stay with family or friends are not entitled to a hotel allowance.

Air travel must be in economy class for any flight shorter than 6 hours. Business class is allowed only for flights longer than 6 hours and only with approval from a vice president. Train travel is in second class air-conditioned coaches. For local travel, employees should use a metro or a shared cab where possible, and a private cab only when no other option exists.

All expense claims must be submitted with original receipts within 15 days of the end of the trip. Claims submitted after 15 days will be rejected unless the finance team has approved a late submission in advance. Claims above Rs 20,000 require approval from the department head before payment. Reimbursements are paid within 10 working days of approval. Employees who use their personal car for official work are paid Rs 12 per kilometre.

5. IT and Information Security

Every employee receives a company laptop, which is replaced every 36 months. Employees must not install software that has not been approved by the IT team, and company laptops must not be used for personal file sharing or gaming. The IT help desk is open from 8:00 in the morning to 8:00 in the evening on working days.

Passwords must have at least 14 characters. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, the HR portal, the source code repository and the finance system. Employees who work outside the office must connect to the company network through the VPN, which is called TunnelOne. Passwords must never be shared, even with colleagues or with the IT team.

If an employee receives a suspicious email, they must not click any link in it. The email should be forwarded to security@nimbuscycles.example, and the security team will respond within one hour. If a laptop, phone or any other company device is lost or stolen, the employee must report it within 4 hours so that the device can be locked remotely. Customer data, including names, phone numbers and addresses, may only be stored on approved company systems and must never be copied to personal email or messaging apps.

6. Customer Returns and Warranty

Customers can return a new Nimbus bicycle within 14 days of delivery if it is unused and in its original packaging. After the bicycle reaches the Coimbatore plant and passes inspection, the refund is processed within 7 business days. The cost of return shipping is paid by Nimbus Cycles if the bicycle arrived damaged, and by the customer in all other cases.

All Nimbus bicycles come with a warranty. The frame is covered for 5 years. The motor is covered for 3 years. The battery is covered for 24 months or 800 full charge cycles, whichever comes first. Accessories such as lights, bells and mudguards are covered for 6 months. The warranty does not cover normal wear of tyres, brake pads and chains.

The warranty becomes void if the bicycle is modified, for example if the motor controller is changed to increase the top speed, or if the battery is opened by anyone other than an authorised service centre. To make a warranty claim, the customer must contact customer support with the serial number of the bicycle, which is printed under the bottom bracket. Support staff must reply to every warranty claim within 2 working days. Repairs done under warranty are free of charge, including parts and labour.

7. Battery Safety

All Nimbus bicycles use a lithium-ion battery rated at 36 volts and 10.4 ampere-hours. A fully charged battery gives a range of up to 70 kilometres on a flat road with a rider of average weight. The range is lower on hills, in strong headwinds and when the highest assist level is used. A full charge from empty takes about 4.5 hours using the original charger.

The battery should be charged only at temperatures between 5 and 35 degrees Celsius. It should never be charged in direct sunlight or in a place where the temperature is likely to be above 35 degrees. Customers must use only the original charger supplied with the bicycle, because chargers from other brands can damage the battery cells and may cause a fire.

A battery should not be left charging for more than 8 hours, and it should never be charged while unattended overnight in a closed room. If the battery becomes unusually hot, swells, makes a hissing noise or gives off a strange smell, the customer should stop using it immediately, disconnect the charger and move the bicycle outdoors away from anything that can burn. Damaged batteries must be returned to a Nimbus service centre, and must never be thrown away with ordinary household waste. Nimbus Cycles recycles every returned battery at its Coimbatore plant.

8. Hiring, Performance and Notice

New employees at Nimbus Cycles have a probation period of 6 months. During probation, either side can end the employment with 15 days of notice. After probation is confirmed, the notice period is 60 days for all employees, whether they resign or the company ends their employment.

Performance reviews are held twice a year, in March and in September. Each employee is rated on a scale from 1 to 5, where 1 means needs major improvement and 5 means outstanding. Ratings are discussed in a one-to-one meeting with the manager, and the employee has the right to add written comments to the review. Salary increments are decided only in the March review.

Nimbus Cycles encourages employees to refer friends and former colleagues for open positions. A referral bonus of Rs 25,000 is paid when the referred person completes 6 months with the company. The bonus is paid only once for each person hired, and managers cannot receive a bonus for referring someone who will report directly to them. Open positions are listed on the careers page and on the intranet every Monday. The hiring process has three rounds: a screening call, a technical or practical interview, and a final discussion with the department head.

9. Learning and Benefits

Every employee has an annual learning budget of Rs 40,000. The budget can be used for courses, certifications, books and conferences that are related to the employee's work. The manager must approve the plan before the money is spent, and the employee must share what they learned with the team in a short session within a month of finishing the course.

All employees and their immediate family members are covered by group health insurance with a cover of Rs 5 lakh per family per year. The insurance covers hospital stays, day-care procedures and ambulance charges. Employees can add their parents to the policy by paying an additional premium, which is deducted from the salary in twelve equal parts.

Employees can claim a gym or sports reimbursement of Rs 1,000 per month on submission of a membership receipt. Every November, the whole company goes on a two-day annual offsite in Goa, where teams spend time together, present their work and celebrate the year. The company also gives a Diwali gift voucher worth Rs 5,000 to each employee, and a free lunch is served in the Pune head office every Friday.

10. Code of Conduct and Contacts

All employees are expected to act honestly and treat colleagues, customers and suppliers with respect. Harassment, discrimination and bullying are not tolerated in any form. Employees must not accept gifts worth more than Rs 2,000 from suppliers or customers, and any such gift must be reported to the manager.

Concerns about unethical behaviour can be reported by email to ethics@nimbuscycles.example. Reports can be made anonymously. Every complaint is investigated, and the investigation must be completed within 21 days. Nimbus Cycles protects employees who report in good faith, and any retaliation against such an employee is itself treated as serious misconduct that can lead to dismissal.

The Human Resources team is led by Kavya Menon, who can be reached at hr@nimbuscycles.example for questions about leave, payroll, benefits and policies. Questions about information security should be sent to the IT security team, and questions about customer warranty claims should go to customer support. This handbook was last updated in October 2026 and is reviewed by the HR team every year. Employees who notice an error or an outdated rule should inform HR so that it can be corrected.